Carlos Santisteban

Portfolio: carlos.santisteban.site

Full-Stack Engineer

React, TypeScript, Node.js, APIs, realtime features, and shipped web apps

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Berlin, Germany | Mexican & Spanish EU citizen

SUMMARY

Full-stack product engineer with 8+ years of experience building user-facing web applications and practical end-to-end product slices. Strongest in React, TypeScript, JavaScript, and modern frontend development, with hands-on experience across Node.js, REST/GraphQL APIs, PostgreSQL, WebSockets, scraping/enrichment pipelines, PWA/offline behavior, deployment, debugging, and iteration. Experienced with product, design, and backend collaboration in production environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend & Architecture:
React, TypeScript, JavaScript, component architecture, Redux Toolkit, React Context, TanStack Query, Zustand, Apollo Client, complex product workflows, responsive UI, SSR, routing, monorepos, Material UI, styled-components

Data & Product Delivery:
GraphQL, REST APIs, Node.js, PostgreSQL, WebSockets, browser APIs, PWA/offline support, performance, technical SEO, Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Quality & Engineering Practices:
Unit, component, and end-to-end testing, debugging, code review, technical planning, mentoring, cross-functional collaboration, AI-assisted development

EXPERIENCE

Independent Web Development
Berlin | Apr 2025 - Present

Web apps, UX, and AI-assisted delivery workflows

Designed and built independent React/TypeScript web applications across polished UI, search/filter and comparison flows, realtime interactions, PWA/offline behavior, data pipelines, deployment automation, debugging, and iteration. Applied modern web tooling, full-stack delivery patterns, and AI-assisted development workflows while owning architecture decisions, product direction, and final behavior.

Lingoda
Berlin | Jun 2021 - Mar 2025

Software Engineer - Language learning platform

Built user-facing features for a live online language learning platform. Had major frontend ownership of Lingobites student-facing exercise flows, including interactive UI, multiple exercise types, routing, animations, state handling, progress tracking, gamification, and flashcard integration. Helped replace a constrained third-party quiz system with an in-house solution, working with React, Apollo/GraphQL, Material UI, product, design, backend, QA, bug fixing, and release iteration.

Quandoo
Berlin | Sep 2017 - Jan 2021

Software Engineer - Restaurant reservation platform

Built and improved the consumer restaurant booking site across search, discovery, reservation, promotional, SEO, and performance surfaces. Led investigation and planning for a major React Router migration, mapping dependencies, comparing options, documenting tradeoffs, and helping preserve custom SSR and styled-components behavior while unblocking React/library upgrades. Also worked on metadata, canonicals, internal linking, indexability, availability filters, and time-to-first-paint/time-to-interactive improvements.

Market Logic Software
Berlin | Mar 2016 - Jul 2016

Web Developer - Data visualization UIs

Built data-heavy UI components, interactive graphs, and dynamic widgets with React and D3.js for an enterprise market intelligence platform. Worked on interfaces that translated research and insight data into usable visual product surfaces.

AISA
Mexico | Apr 2015 - Jun 2015

Software Developer - Government document systems

Built UI forms and controls for legal document management systems using C#, WPF, and SQL databases. Contributed to internal software for capturing, validating, and managing structured document data in government workflows.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of IT Engineering - Tecnologico de Monterrey, Mexico
Aug 2012 - May 2017

Coursework: object-oriented programming, data structures, databases, networks, servers, operating systems, IT security, and cloud computing. DAAD scholarship exchange semester in Informatics at Hochschule Furtwangen, Germany.